



October 27th 2020 Delaware County Council Meeting

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=f4iErTGHm3w
Publication Date	2020-10-27T14:07:00Z
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Delaware County Council Meeting Summary

Meeting Date: October 27, 2020

Meeting Time: 9:00 AM

1. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Presiding officer opened the Delaware County Council meeting of October 27, 2020, at 9:00 AM [00:00:11](#). Public questions were directed to be submitted to countycouncil-dist@co.delaware.in.us [00:01:07](#).
- **Attendance:**
 - **Members Present:** Mr. Ballard, Mr. Bledsoe, Ms. Chambers, Ms. Lasseter, Ms. Piper, Mr. Quakenbush, Mr. Alexander (Presiding Officer), and Mr. Hughes.
 - **Members Absent:** Paul (Communication Center Director, noted absent) [00:04:29](#).
 - **Presiding Officer:** Mr. Alexander.

2. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** The meeting opened with the Pledge of Allegiance led by Ron [00:00:24](#).

- **Approval of Agenda:** The agenda was confirmed as posted and advertised [00:03:33](#). A motion to approve was made and seconded, and approved by roll call vote (Passed Unanimously) [00:03:37](#).
 - **Approval of Minutes:** Minutes from the Special Council Meeting on September 16, 2020, the regular Council Meeting on September 22, 2020, and the Special Council Meeting on October 1, 2020, were approved collectively. A motion was made and seconded, and approved by roll call vote (Passed Unanimously) [00:02:05](#).
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3. Substantive Business & Board Action

- [00:03:25](#) **Communication Center Transfers**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Presented on behalf of the Communication Center (Director Paul not present).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** A series of line-item transfers covering education incentives, training, communication tech, maintenance supplies, and transportation. These had previously been approved at the finance committee meeting.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote (Passed Unanimously) [00:04:49](#).
- [00:05:10](#) **Family Support Transfers**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Department staff.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Line-item adjustments (assistant and related accounts) totaling zero net change.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote (Passed Unanimously) [00:05:34](#).
- [00:05:44](#) **Jail Budget Transfers**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Donna (Staff).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Various adjustments including holiday overtime (\$21,350), inmate clothing, uniforms, equipment repair, contracts, and schooling.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote (Passed Unanimously) [00:07:02](#).
- [00:07:16](#) **Treasurer's Office Transfers**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Treasurer's Office staff.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Transfer moving \$3,000 from printing to furniture and computers (net zero request).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote (Passed Unanimously) [00:07:38](#).
- [00:07:49](#) **Public Defender's Office Transfers**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Public Defender staff.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Transfer of \$5,000 from psychological testing to attorney fees.

- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote (Passed Unanimously) 00:08:27.
- 00:08:43 **Public Defender Supplemental Transfers**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Public Defender staff.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Adjustments adding \$1,850 to attorney fees while reducing file maintenance, witness fees, dues/subscriptions, and travel expenses.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote (Passed Unanimously) 00:09:21.
- 00:09:37 **Board of Health Transfer (Removal from Table)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Council / Health Department.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** A motion was made to take the previously tabled Board of Health item off the table (\$20,000 from environmental health specialist to overtime), noting it is reimbursable through CARES Act funding.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:**
 - Motion to remove from table: Approved by roll call vote (Passed Unanimously) 00:10:00.
 - Motion to approve transfer: Approved by roll call vote (Passed Unanimously) 00:10:59.
- 00:11:12 **Transfer Addendum (Communication Center & Insurance Adjustments)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Council / Donna.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Adjustments for the communication center (including telephone backup center and overtime) and public defender insurance adjustments. Reductions were made to insurance line items to minimize general fund impact.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote (Passed Unanimously) 00:12:15 (and 00:13:48).
- 00:14:04 **Election Board Transfers**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Election Board staff.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Reallocating funds from deputy election commissioner and overtime into absent/absentee voter board accounts.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote (Passed Unanimously) 00:14:49.
- 00:15:05 **Financial Agenda: Sheriff's Office Staffing Reallocations**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Sheriff Tony Skinner.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Sheriff Skinner explained rank promotions triggered by the retirement of a long-time lieutenant (Greg Ellison), cascading promotions from sergeant to lieutenant, corporal to sergeant, and patrolman to corporal. The Sheriff also discussed delayed hiring for the upcoming February 15 academy class due to reduced academy capacity (bedding reduced from three to two per room).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote (Passed Unanimously) 00:18:28.

- **00:18:45 Financial Agenda: Public Defender Adjustments**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Public Defender / Council.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Transcript fee request (\$15,000) withdrawn; leaving a net request of \$23,000 for attorney fees after finding internal savings.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote (Passed Unanimously) [00:19:48](#).
- **00:20:06 Financial Agenda: Data Processing / Edit Projects**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Data Processing / IT.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** IT requests withdrawn; edit projects appropriation request finalized at \$2,788,000 to cover operational costs through the end of the year.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote (Passed Unanimously) [00:21:20](#).
- **00:21:38 Eviction ADR Courts Transfer**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Court staff.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Transfer of \$1,150 into contract services.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote (Passed Unanimously) [00:22:04](#).
- **00:22:16 GIS COVID Grant Transfer**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Department staff.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Transfer of \$4,000 (\$400 for gasoline, \$3,600 for contractual services) under the COVID grant.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote (Passed Unanimously) [00:22:40](#).
- **00:22:52 MVH Restricted Fund (County Highway Paving)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Kerry Dye, County Highway.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Request for \$800,000 in the Motor Vehicle Highway (MVH) restricted fund for bituminous materials. Council members (specifically Ron and the presiding officer) engaged in an extensive critique of state mandates requiring counties to split MVH funds 50/50 between operational/payroll and restricted road materials, expressing frustration over state overreach and the impacts of the wheel tax. Kerry Dye confirmed the highway department utilizes its own equipment and personnel for paving when possible.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote (Passed Unanimously) [00:29:17](#).
- **00:29:34 Comprehensive Financial Transfer & Ordinance Amendment**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Council.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Motion to approve financial transfers, amend the salary ordinance (with reductions), and amend the hiring freeze ordinance (Ordinance 2020-015).

- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote (Passed Unanimously) 00:29:57.
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4. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

No formal public comment session or citizen forum was conducted during this meeting, though council members discussed public voting logistics.

5. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - Jane raised a procedural question regarding visitor bureau appointments, noting terms will expire and require off-season discussion.
 - Council members offered public commendations/kudos to:
 - The Prosecutor's Office for successful major case convictions 00:31:15.
 - The Clerk's Office and Rick's team for smooth early voting operations 00:31:41. Reminders were given that early voting runs through the week (8:30 AM to 4:00 PM) and Saturday (until noon), with Election Day on Tuesday 00:31:57.
 - EMS for maintaining high standards 00:33:45.
 - Administrative note made regarding upcoming payroll line cleanups at the next month's meeting 00:32:34. Mention made of COVID precautions taken by the commissioners and staff (noting Paul's absence due to safety precautions) 00:33:15.
 - **Adjournment:** A motion to adjourn was made and seconded, and approved by roll call vote (Passed Unanimously) 00:33:56. Meeting adjourned.
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